

Policy on ACEnet Support of Conferences

ACEnet recognizes the benefits to be gained from conferences and is prepared to help support conferences related to high performance computing (HPC) run by ACEnet users. ACEnet commits to responding to the conference proposer with a decision within six weeks of receiving a proposal which includes all the required information. It is expected that proposals which ACEnet deems meet all the requirements will receive funding. The requirements and proposed process are given:

Requirements

- 1) The conference must be sponsored by an ACEnet member institution. The proposal must include a letter from the sponsoring institution indicating what resources (cash and/or in-kind) the institution is providing for the conference
- 2) The faculty member leading the conference (head of the Local Organizing Committee) must be an ACEnet user.
- 3) The theme of the conference must be strongly related to HPC. It is not sufficient to have HPC be a small component of a more general conference.
- 4) ACEnet will contribute to conferences at a set rate which will depend on whether the conference is regional, national, or international. Proposed rates for 2008-9 are included in a table accompanying this draft. In the event that the discipline of the proposed conference falls under one of the ACEnet Institutes, it is expected that the specific ACEnet Institute will decide whether to fund the conference at the regional conference rate from their allotted resources. If the relevant Institute decides to fund the conference at the regional rate, the faculty member leading the conference may apply to ACEnet directly to make up the difference between the regional and national or international rates as appropriate.
- 5) When a proposal to fund a conference is made, the requestor will indicate whether the conference is expected to be regional, national, or international. When accepted, ACEnet will immediately release the first \$1000 to the sponsoring institution. The remainder will be released once ACEnet has been provided with an attendance list including participant affiliation. The requirement for a national or international meeting is that the faculty from Atlantic Canadian institutions will comprise no more than 80% of the total faculty attendance. For the purposes of this accounting, attending faculty members whose home institutions are outside Atlantic Canada but who are on sabbatical at an Atlantic Canadian institution will be considered as Atlantic Canadian.
- 6) It is expected that a report will be filed with ACEnet after the conference in which the thoughts of knowledgeable participants on the adequacy of ACEnet facilities and the directions in which ACEnet should go will be included
- 7) It is expected that due recognition of ACEnet support will be made during the conference.

Elements of the Proposal

- 1) The proposal may be submitted at any time.

- 2) The proposal must include an official letter from the sponsoring ACEnet member institution outlining its support, including financial or in kind, for the meeting.
- 3) The proposal must include the title of the conference, the dates, and a general description of the theme.
- 4) The proposal must include information about the intended audience (e.g., computational chemists, all chemists, etc.).
- 5) The proposal must include an indication as to whether the expected conference attendance is expected to be small (<30), medium (30 – 100), or large (>100).
- 6) The proposal may include a list of invited speakers, the members of the Local Organizing Committee, and the members of the Scientific Organizing Committee.

Proposed ACEnet Conference Support Rates for 2008-9

Scale of Conference	ACEnet Funding Level
Regional	\$1000
National	\$1500
International	\$2000